

IN-DEPTH: TN DISPLAYS

The advent of LCD Displays

Even though they have become very rare nowadays, most of us have seen a Cathode Ray Tube (CRT) display, either as a television set or as the monitor for a personal computer. They were massive, difficult to move and plug (Anyone who has ever tried to connect a VCR/DVD/Video Game player to a CRT TV can vouch for the gymnastics involved). Hence it was no surprise when even after ruling the display market since their commercial launch in the 1930's, they disappeared quickly when a new piece of technology made the much slimmer and better looking LCD displays practical. That technology is the Twisted Nematic Field effect, or simply put, TN effect.

A majority of the displays sold currently are TN displays. It is no surprise, given that it is one of the cheapest type of displays to produce and has a very low response time because of its ability to change state faster than any other LCD technology in the market. It is due to this ability, that TN displays are chosen by those in the gaming profession.

Compared to its predecessor, LCDs in the form of TN displays are better in almost every aspect. To begin with, they were almost 90 percent slimmer and almost 10 kg lighter on an average than their bulky CRT counterparts. The displays on LCDs are truly flat compared to the curvature necessary on CRTs. Since there is not a major need for thick outer frames, LCDs offer a much better screen size with respect to total size as compared to CRTs.